Formal Playbook

PB - Google SecOps

MERGE TechOps Playbook

Document Control

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1. Purpose

This document defines the operational playbook for Google Security Operations within MERGE TechOps. This playbook is intended for security personnel, system administrators, and TechOps team members who require quick-reference operational guidance for day-to-day security operations activities.

1. This playbook provides operational quick-reference materials, including critical URLs, emergency contacts, daily checklists, incident response procedures, and infrastructure details for the Google SecOps platform integrated with Foresite MSSP services.
2. The playbook complements the Security Operations Policy and Procedures with quick, actionable references for the team.

2. Scope

This playbook applies to all MERGE full-time and part-time employees, MERGE interns, MERGE contract workers, and all providers when rendering services as a Business Associate. Persons under contract providing work-related services to MERGE must adhere to these procedures, but will have limited access to company chat spaces, with access only to communications directly related to their current contracted work.

- Applies To: Information Security, TechOps, Security Operations personnel
- Systems Involved: Google SecOps Enterprise+, Foresite Citadel MXDR, Catalyst Portal, Tenable VM, Bindplane, SentinelOne EDR
- Exclusions: Policy governance matters; detailed step-by-step procedures

3. Roles and Responsibilities

1. Information Security Team

    a. Uses playbook for case triage, incident response coordination, and threat intelligence operations.
2. TechOps
    a. Uses playbook for infrastructure reference, agent deployment verification, and escalation procedures.
3. Managers
    a. References playbook for escalation matrix and service contact information.
4. Security Officer
    a. Reviews playbook for accuracy and alignment with policy requirements.
5. RACI MATRIX
    a. The following RACI matrix defines accountability for security operations activities across MERGE, Foresite MSSP, and Google platform responsibilities.
    b. Legend: R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

Activity	MERGE InfoSec	Foresite SOC	Google
Security Policy Management	A/R	C	I
24/7 Security Monitoring	A	R	C
Incident Detection & Triage	A	R	C
Incident Response & Containment	A/R	R	C
Vulnerability Scanning	A	R	I
Vulnerability Remediation	A/R	C	I
Detection Rule Engineering	A	R	C
Threat Intelligence Integration	A	C	R
Platform Availability & SLA	I	C	A/R
Log Ingestion & Data Pipeline	A	R	C
Compliance Reporting	A/R	C	I
Executive Security Reporting	A/R	C	I

4. Definitions

4.1. Key Words

Define key terms related to this playbook and the systems it references.

1. GTI: Google Threat Intelligence - integrated threat intelligence platform including Mandiant frontline intelligence and VirusTotal capabilities.
2. Catalyst: Foresite's case management and service portal for security operations.
3. TAM: Technical Account Manager - dedicated Foresite contact for service escalations.

5. Playbook Overview

The following sections provide operational quick-reference materials for security operations activities.

5.1. Critical URLs

Primary access points for security operations platforms.

Platform	URL
Google SecOps Console	https://mergeworld.backstory.chronicle.security
Catalyst Case Portal	https://catalyst.foresite.com/merge/cases
Bindplane Console	https://bindplane.com
Ingestion Dashboard	https://catalyst.foresite.com/merge/dashboards/ingestion
GCP Security Command Center	https://console.cloud.google.com/security/command-center

5.2. Emergency Contacts

Foresite SOC and escalation contacts for security operations support.

Contact Type	Details
SOC Phone (US)	+1 (866) 478-8324
SOC Phone (UK)	+ 44 (800) 358-4915
SOC Email	soc@foresite.com, support@catalyst.foresite.com
Whitelist Number	(913) 336-2017
TAM (Sam, Mark)	sam.waris@foresite.com, mark.lavallee@foresite.com

5.3. Daily Operations Checklist

Morning review tasks for security operations personnel.

4. Review overnight cases in Catalyst portal - filter by Critical/High priority
5. Check ingestion health dashboard for data gaps
6. Review any pending escalations requiring MERGE validation
7. Verify SecOps console access and functionality
8. Check GTI alerts for emerging threats affecting monitored assets

5.4. Severity Classification

Incident severity levels and response time requirements.

Severity	Description	Response Time
Critical	Active breach, data exfiltration	15 minutes
High	Confirmed malware, compromised account	1 hour
Medium	Suspicious activity, policy violation	4 hours
Low	Informational, tuning required	Next business day

5.5. Incident Response Quick Actions

Compromised Account Response:

1. Disable account in Entra ID immediately
2. Revoke all active sessions and refresh tokens
3. Investigate sign-in logs and audit trail
4. Force password reset with MFA re-enrollment
5. Re-enable account after verification
6. Document incident in Catalyst case

Malware Detection Response:

1. Verify SentinelOne has isolated the endpoint
2. Apply network containment if not auto-isolated
3. Investigate process tree and lateral movement
4. Eradicate malware and persistence mechanisms
5. Reimage or recover endpoint as required
6. Hunt for related IOCs across the environment

5.6. Ingestion Health Thresholds

Data source monitoring thresholds for alerting on ingestion gaps.

Data Source	Expected Frequency	Alert Threshold
SentinelOne EDR	Continuous	15 minute gap
Entra ID / Workspace	Near real-time	30 minute gap
Cisco Meraki	Syslog UDP	1 hour gap
Cloud Audit Logs	Batch 5-15 min	1 hour gap

5.7. GTI Monitored Domains

Domains monitored by Google Threat Intelligence for attack surface management.

Domain	Domain
mergeworld.com	mcinteractivegroup.com
mergeworlddata.com	mergeatlanta.com
merge-it.com	mergeboston.com
partnersandsimons.com	mergechicago.com
aviddesign.com	mergewell.com
beamland.com	myelincommunications.com
blazerconsulting.com	myelinhealth.com
bluemoondigital.co	perkuto.com
digesto.io	sandboxww.com
dodgecommunications.com	underlinecom.com
gacommunication.com	ymarketing.com
jeto.io	zeejaydigital.com

5.8. Infrastructure Reference

GCP security infrastructure configuration details.

VPC Configuration:

- VPC Name: security-monitoring-vpc
- Subnet: nessus-syslog (10.2.0.0/28)
- Region: us-central1-a

Security VMs:

VM Name	IP Address	Backup Window
gcp-secops-syslog01	10.2.0.4	9:00 PM - 10:00 PM
gcp-secops-nessus-scan01	10.2.0.6	3:00 AM - 4:00 AM

DLP Service Agent Containers within SecOps folder of each GCP Organization:

- Mergeworld DLP SAC
- Mergeworlddata DLP SAC
- Merge-IT DLP SAC

5.9. SSO Configuration Reference

Authentication configuration for Google SecOps access.

- Workforce Pool: secops-entra-pool
- Provider: secops-entra-provider
- Sign-on URL: https://mergeworld.backstory.chronicle.security
- Credential Vault: 1Password - TechOps - InfoSec Operations

6. Troubleshooting & Error Handling

Compliance with this playbook is mandatory for all employees, contractors, and stakeholders. Reference POL-001 for governance and PROC-001 for detailed procedures.

6.1. Escalation Matrix

Situation	Initial Contact	Escalation Path
Critical Incident	SOC Hotline	TAM → Leadership
Service Degradation	TAM Email	Foresite Management
Ingestion Failure	Catalyst Case	SOC Phone
Detection Tuning	Catalyst Case	TAM

6.2. Standing Rules of Engagement

1. All credentials stored in 1Password - TechOps - InfoSec Operations vault
2. Access governance managed through SSO groups in Entra ID
3. Catalyst portal requires SSO - no shared accounts
4. Maintain current contact sheet in Catalyst portal
5. Verify callback requests using whitelist number

7. Compliance with Security Considerations

This playbook supports compliance with HITRUST r2 v11.5, SOC 2, and ISO 27001 requirements. Any deviations from playbook guidance should be documented and reported to the Security Officer.

8. Review & Change Management

This playbook shall be reviewed regularly and updated as necessary to reflect changes in security operations requirements.

8.1. Review Frequency

- Quarterly Review: Minor updates for clarity and process improvements.
- Annual Review: Full compliance and security review by TechOps leadership.
- Ad Hoc Updates: Immediate updates as required for urgent process changes.

8.2. Approval Workflow

All updates to this playbook must go through:

- Review by Playbook Owner
- Compliance & Security Validation
- Approval by TechOps Leadership

Once approved, the updated playbook is published and versioned in the Technical Documentation Repository.

9. Related Documents

This playbook operates in conjunction with the following policy and procedure documents.

Related Policy:

- POL - Google SecOps

Related Procedure:

- PROC - Google SecOps

Revision History

Version	Date	Edited By	Approved by
1.0	December 2025	MERGE InfoSec	TechOps Leadership

This document is controlled and maintained by MERGE TechOps. Unauthorized alterations are prohibited.

Running Playbook

Informal Project Playbook

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